cholera, dysentery, and the plague were epidemic annually. To-day the mountai.is are reafforested; railway, telephone, and

telegraph systems are excellent; the public health service is highly efficient, good highways abound; flood-control and irrigation works have vastly increased the food production, and

fine harbours have been developed and well managed. The country has become so prosperous

and healthy that the 1905 population of 11,000,000 has risen to 24,000,000 and the

average scale of living to-day is almost immeasurably higher than it was at the turn of the century.' But Mr. Abend points out that all this material improvement has not been instituted for the benefit of the Korean people but so that greater profits might go to the Japanese.

stable and progressive society was built up, though the stress was always more on stability and security and the survival of the race. In later years the dynamic aspect began to fade away, and in the name of eternal principles the social structure was made rigid and unchanging. It was, as a matter of fact, not wholly rigid and it did change gradually and continuously. But the ideology behind it and the general framework continued unchanged. The group idea as represented by more or less autonomous castes, the joint family and the communal self-governing life of the village were the main pillars of this system,